

IT PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO

Cloud Engineering and Security Projects

PROJECT 20

Delegate IAM Identity Center and CloudTrail Administration

AWS Organizations | IAM Identity Center | CloudTrail | Delegated Administration

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ENVIRONMENT	Personal AWS Lab
VERSION	v1.0.0
RELEASE DATE	July 15, 2026
STATUS	Complete

Executive Summary

Delegated administration for two organization-level AWS services to purpose-built member accounts. **IAM Identity Center** delegated administration was assigned to the **IAM** account, and **CloudTrail** delegated administration was assigned to the **SecurityAudit** account. This reduces the need to use the AWS Organizations management account for routine service administration.

Business Problem

The AWS Organizations management account is highly privileged. Operators working there can affect identity, logging, account governance, and downstream member accounts. Reducing routine management-account usage lowers blast radius and supports least-privilege operations. Delegated administration allows specific member accounts to administer supported organization services after initial setup from the management account.

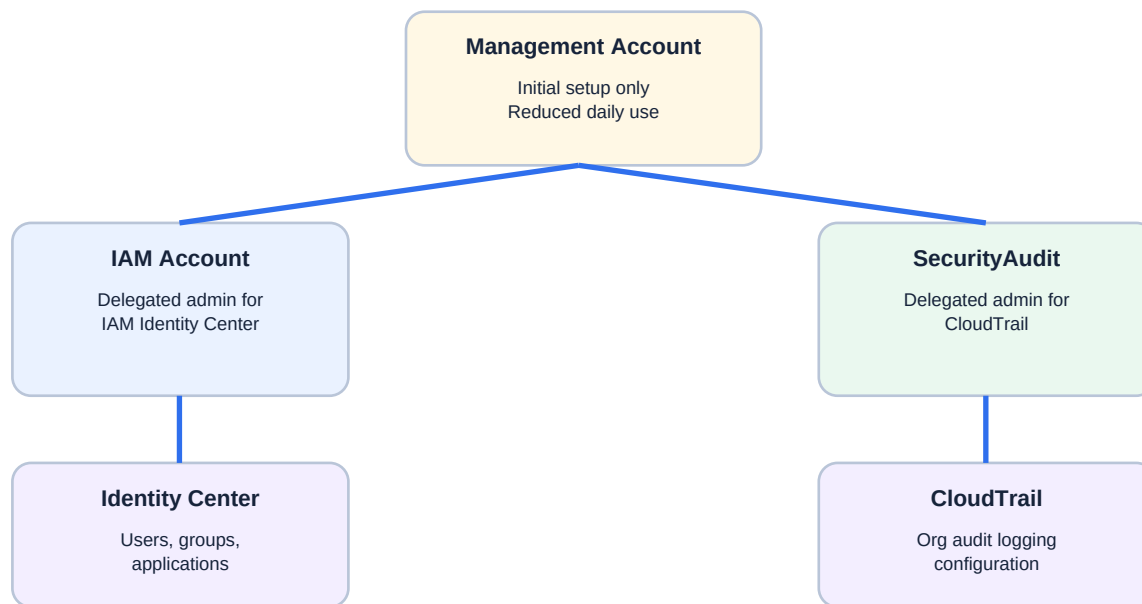
Objectives

- Register the IAM account as delegated administrator for IAM Identity Center.
- Register the SecurityAudit account as delegated administrator for CloudTrail.
- Reduce routine use of the AWS Organizations management account.
- Keep identity administration aligned with the dedicated IAM account.
- Keep CloudTrail security monitoring administration aligned with SecurityAudit.
- Document that delegated administration is configured per service and may behave differently by service.

Environment

Cloud Provider	Amazon Web Services (AWS)
Governance Service	AWS Organizations
Identity Service Delegated	IAM Identity Center
IAM Identity Center Delegated Admin	IAM account
Security Logging Service Delegated	AWS CloudTrail
CloudTrail Delegated Admin	SecurityAudit account
Primary Goal	Reduce routine access to the management account
Management Account Role	Initial setup and organization-level control remains in management account
Evidence Limitation	Evidence confirms delegated registration for IAM Identity Center and CloudTrail; it does not show a later administrative action performed from the delegated accounts.

Architecture



Delegated administration moves routine service administration out of the management account and into purpose-built security accounts.

Figure 1 - Delegated administration model for IAM Identity Center and CloudTrail.

Implementation Summary

1. Signed into the IAM Identity Center access portal and selected AdministratorAccess for the management account.
2. Opened IAM Identity Center settings in the Oregon region.
3. Opened the Management tab and registered the IAM account as IAM Identity Center delegated administrator.
4. Validated that IAM appeared as the delegated administrator for IAM Identity Center.
5. Opened AWS Organizations and copied the SecurityAudit account ID from the Security OU.
6. Opened CloudTrail settings from the management account context.
7. Registered SecurityAudit as an organization delegated administrator for CloudTrail.
8. Validated that SecurityAudit appeared as the organization delegated administrator for CloudTrail.

SCOPE

Delegated administration reduces management-account usage, but it does not eliminate the management account. Initial setup, some service enablement tasks, and certain organization-level changes still require the management account.

Delegation Map

IAM Identity Center	IAM	Centralizes workforce identity administration in the dedicated identity account.
AWS CloudTrail	SecurityAudit	Places organization logging administration near the security monitoring function.
LogArchive	Not selected	Stores logs; does not need routine permission to modify CloudTrail configuration.
Management Account	Reduced use	Retains top-level organization control but should not be used for daily service administration.

Evidence

Figure 2 - IAM Account Registered as IAM Identity Center Delegated Administrator

Member account IAM registered successfully as an IAM Identity Center delegated administrator. It might take some time to grant administrative access to this account.

Settings

Details
Configure your identity source and multi-factor authentication settings for use when managing access to your AWS accounts, resources, and cloud applications.

Instance name - Edit	Instance ID	Organization ID
Instance type Organization instance	Primary Region	Date created Monday, July 13, 2026 at 12:24:02 PM MDT
Instance ARN	Delegated administrator Registered account: IAM	Identity-enhanced sessions - Enable Disabled

[Enable identity-enhanced sessions](#)
Identity-enhanced sessions provide personalized experiences for users of AWS managed applications. Identity-enhanced sessions are required for some of these applications, such as Kiro in the console. [Learn about identity-enhanced sessions](#)

[Enable](#)

Identity source | Authentication | Attributes for access control | **Management** | Tags

Key for encrypting IAM Identity Center data at rest
Provides enhanced security by encrypting all your data at rest using encryption keys stored in AWS Key Management Service. [Learn more](#)

[Manage encryption](#)

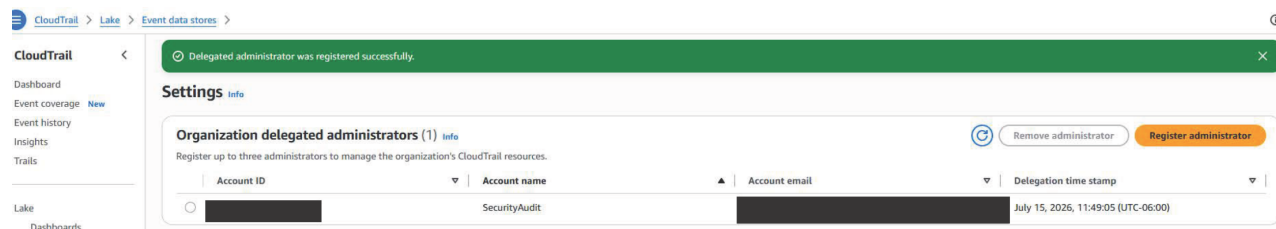
Delegated administrator
When you register a member account in your organization as a delegated administrator, users in the account who have sufficient permissions will have administrative access to IAM Identity Center. They can administer other users, manage their permissions, and application assignments. [Learn more](#)

[Deregister account](#)

Account name IAM	Account ID
Account email	

The IAM Identity Center evidence shows the success banner confirming that member account IAM was registered successfully as an IAM Identity Center delegated administrator. The Settings page also shows Delegated administrator: Registered account IAM. Sensitive instance, organization, account, and email identifiers were redacted.

Figure 3 - SecurityAudit Registered as CloudTrail Delegated Administrator



The CloudTrail evidence shows the success banner confirming that the delegated administrator was registered successfully. The Organization delegated administrators table shows SecurityAudit as the registered delegated administrator for CloudTrail. Sensitive account and email identifiers were redacted.

Security Analysis

This project reduces exposure of the management account by shifting routine IAM Identity Center administration to IAM and CloudTrail administration to SecurityAudit.

The IAM account is the correct destination for Identity Center delegation because it is the dedicated account for identity administration and future access management workflows.

SecurityAudit is the correct destination for CloudTrail delegation because it is intended for security monitoring and audit administration. LogArchive stores logs, but should not necessarily administer logging configuration.

Delegating each service to a purpose-built account supports least privilege and reduces blast radius if a delegated account is compromised.

Delegated administration is service-specific. Controls, limits, and administrative scope differ between IAM Identity Center and CloudTrail, so each service must be validated separately.

Lessons Learned

Delegated administration is a key management-account hardening pattern in AWS Organizations.

The management account is powerful and difficult to restrict with SCPs, so reducing routine use is a major security improvement.

Dedicated delegated-administration accounts should align with function: identity operations belong in IAM, while CloudTrail security administration belongs in SecurityAudit.

Log storage and log administration are separate responsibilities. Keeping LogArchive focused on storage helps preserve separation of duties.

Production Improvements

- Create least-privilege permission sets for Identity Center administrators in the IAM account.
- Create least-privilege permission sets for CloudTrail administrators in SecurityAudit.
- Monitor delegated administrator registration and deregistration events in CloudTrail.
- Document which organization services are delegated, to which accounts, and why.

- Separate log-read, log-admin, and identity-admin duties through dedicated permission sets and groups.
- Review delegated administrator accounts regularly and remove unused or stale delegations.

Skills Demonstrated

Delegated administration	IAM Identity Center	AWS CloudTrail
AWS Organizations	Management-account hardening	Least privilege
Security account design	Separation of duties	Blast-radius reduction

Resume Bullet

RESUME

Reduced AWS Organizations management-account usage by delegating IAM Identity Center administration to a dedicated IAM account and CloudTrail administration to SecurityAudit, improving separation of duties and reducing operational blast radius.

STAR Interview Story

Situation: The AWS organization had IAM Identity Center and CloudTrail configured, but routine administration still depended on the highly privileged management account.

Task: Move supported service administration into purpose-built member accounts to reduce management-account usage.

Action: I registered the IAM account as delegated administrator for IAM Identity Center and registered SecurityAudit as delegated administrator for CloudTrail, then validated both successful registrations.

Result: The environment now supports delegated administration for identity and logging services, reducing reliance on the management account and improving separation of duties.

Version History

v1.0.0	July 15, 2026	Initial documented implementation. Registered IAM as IAM Identity Center delegated administrator, registered SecurityAudit as CloudTrail delegated administrator, documented management-account reduction rationale, and embedded provided evidence using portfolio documentation standard v1.0.1.

References

- Cloud Security Lab a Week (S.L.A.W.) - Enable Delegated Administrator for Identity Center and CloudTrail.
- User-provided IAM Identity Center delegated administrator screenshot.

- User-provided CloudTrail delegated administrator screenshot.
- Project 13 - IAM Identity Center SSO and MFA Foundation.
- Project 19 - Button Up AWS Organizations with Alternate Contacts and Workload OUs.